Establishing Certain Entities in the Name or Subject Authority File

H 405

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A. Background

Most headings fall into clearly defined categories and are established either as personal names, corporate bodies, jurisdictions, uniform titles, named meetings, etc., in the name authority file, or as topical headings, named objects such as automobiles, geographic features, etc., in the subject authority file. There are, however, certain named entities that have in the past been problematic as to

- whether the heading should go into the name authority file following descriptive cataloging conventions or the subject authority file following subject cataloging conventions; and
- how the heading should be tagged in both authority and bibliographic records.

To eliminate this confusion and to standardize the formulation and tagging of headings for such entities, the former Office for Descriptive Cataloging Policy (Desc Pol) and the Office for Subject Cataloging Policy (Subj Pol), working under the aegis of the Office of the Director for Cataloging, developed guidelines with respect to

- the responsibility for establishing the headings;

- the conventions to be used in formulating the headings;
- the tags to be used for content designation; and
- the file (name or subject authority) in which authority records for the headings should reside.

The guidelines originally developed by Desc Pol, Subj Pol, and the Director for Cataloging divided the problematic headings into three groups:

1. Headings established according to descriptive cataloging conventions with authority records that always resided in the name authority file;
2. Headings established according to subject cataloging conventions with authority records that resided in the subject authority file unless they were needed for use as descriptive access points; and
3. Headings established in either the name or subject authority file depending upon need for their use as either descriptive access points or as subject headings.

In 1994, the Cooperative Cataloging Council (CCC) established the CPSO/CCC Task Group on Issues Surrounding Maintenance of Separate Name and Subject Authority Files. This task group agreed to reduce the "logical" inconsistencies between the two files so that they could be more easily used together. To this end the task group recommended, and the CCC approved, the deletion from the subject authority file of duplicate records for name headings that had been included in the subject authority file in order to facilitate the production of various products, such as *Library of Congress Subject Headings*.

Duplicate records were deleted from LCSH to the extent practical. A limited number of records were retained in order to preserve scope notes that provide instructions on assignment of the heading as a subject and/or to preserve general see also references. In addition, some records were retained in order to provide UFs for synonymous words or phrases, when those references would not be appropriate for the Name Authority File. Examples of records retained for these reasons include ***Catholic Church***; ***Qur'an***; and ***Bible. English***.

In 1995, the Program for Cooperative Cataloging (PCC) (successor to the CCC) created a follow-on task group, PCC Task Group on Name Versus Subject Authorities, that considered those categories of headings characterized as Group 3 that could be established in either the name or subject authority file (cemeteries, city sections, concentration camps, and country clubs), headings for events, and tagging conventions for certain "geographic" entities. The task group recommended that the headings that were previously established in either the name or subject authority file be established only in the name authority file; that headings for events that are formally convened, directed toward a common goal, capable of being reconvened, and that have a formal name be established in the name authority file instead of the subject authority

file; and that certain entities that were formerly tagged as X51 be tagged as X10, including airports, arboretums, botanical gardens, cemeteries, concentration camps, country clubs, herbariums, and zoological gardens. The PCC approved the task group's recommendations, and the results are reflected in the lists below.

The revised guidelines divide the problematic headings into two groups:

1. Headings always established according to descriptive cataloging conventions with authority records that always reside in the name authority file.
2. Headings always established according to subject cataloging conventions with authority records that
   - reside in the subject authority file if used only as subject headings; or
   - reside in the name authority file if the headings are needed for use as descriptive access points.

Lists of the types of headings falling into both these groups are on pages 4-17. This instruction sheet describes the procedures to be followed when it is necessary for a subject cataloger to establish a heading in one of these categories, or to request a descriptive cataloger to establish a heading for subject usage.

B. Recent revisions

2026-04: Corrected typo.

C. General rule

Whenever a new heading is needed for a named entity, consult the two lists on pages 4-17 to determine whether the heading is categorized as a Group 1 or Group 2 heading. Follow the procedures appropriate to the group. If neither the precise category, nor a broader category that encompasses the precise category, nor a very closely analogous category is found in either of the two groups, bring the matter to the attention of the Policy, Training, and Cooperative Programs Division (PTCP) for an interpretation and possible addition of the category to one of the lists.

D. Group 1 instructions

First search to determine whether the required heading has already been established as an RDA name heading. If so, use the heading as established. If not, establish it as a name heading or request a descriptive cataloger to do so.

If a heading in this category has been established as a *subject* heading, submit a proposal to delete the subject authority record according to the procedures in H 193 after it has been established as a name heading.

E. Group 2 instructions

E.1. Heading required for subject cataloging purposes

First search to determine whether the entity has already been established as a name heading according to former guidelines. After making this determination, proceed as follows:

E.1.a. Name authority record not found

Submit a proposal to establish the entity as a subject heading, following the standard procedures described in H 200, as well as any special procedures described in individual instruction sheets appropriate to particular categories of named entities, for example, H 1334 for buildings and structures, H 1925 for parks, etc.

Proposals of this type appear in the main alphabetical section of the tentative list and are treated as subject headings.

E.1.b. RDA or AACR2 name authority record found

If the record does not have a 667 field with the notation "Subj Headings Manual/RDA," consult the PTCP Division to determine whether it should be canceled as a name heading and re-established as a subject heading.

E.1.c. Pre-AACR2 name authority record found

Submit a proposal to establish it as a subject heading, as described in sec. E.1.a, above. Notify the PTCP Division of the invalid name heading so that the name authority record can be deleted.

E.2. Heading needed for use as descriptive access point

Follow the guidelines in the Descriptive Cataloging Manual, Z1, Appendix 1: Ambiguous Entities, sec. 1.2 and sec. 3.1.

F. Group 1 entities: Name authority headings

Group 1 contains named entities always established according to descriptive cataloging conventions with authority records that always reside in the name authority file.

A-C | D-G | H-R | S-Z

Group 1: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
Abbeys	110	
Academies	110	
Airplanes, Individual	110	
Airports	110	
Almshouses	110	
Animals, Named	100	
Aquariums, Public	110	
Arboretums	110	
Armories	110	
Arsenals	110	
Art works, Individual	100, 110, 130	
Artificial satellites	110	
Asylums (Charitable institutions)	110	
Athletic contests	111	
Banks	110	
Bars	110	
Biblical characters	100	
Biological stations	110	
Boards of trade (Chambers of commerce)	110	
Botanical gardens	110	
Broadcasting stations	110	
Business parks	110	
Cathedrals	110	
Cemeteries	110	Headings in this category are for named cemeteries as corporate bodies. Headings for cemeteries that are archaeological sites include the term Site in the heading and are Group 2, established as subject headings, tagged 151, and qualified according to subject cataloging conventions.
Chambers of commerce	110	
Chapels	110	Headings in this category are for chapels that are free-standing; that is, they are not building details nor parts of complex structures.

Group 1: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
		Headings for chapels that are building details or parts of complex structures are in Group 2, established as subject headings, and tagged 150. See H 1334 sec. 5-6 for information on establishing building details and parts of complex structures.
Churches (in use or ruins)	110	
Circuses	110	
City sections	151	This category includes historic districts and special economic zones in cities.
Collective settlements	151	
Colleges	110	
Comarcas	151	
Comic strips	130	Although headings in this category are generally established under title and tagged 130, those that are established under personal or corporate names are tagged 100 or 110.
Communes	151	
Competitions	111	
Computer programs and software	130	Although headings in this category are generally established under title and tagged 130, those that are established under personal or corporate names are tagged 100 or 110.
Concentration camps	110	
Concert halls	110	
Conservation districts	151	
Contests	111	
Convents	110	
Correctional institutions	110	
Country clubs	110	
Crematories	110	
Dance halls	110	
Denominations, Religious (Individual)	110	
Dispensaries	110	
Ecclesiastical entities that are also names of places, for example, Catholic Church. Diocese of Basel (Switzerland);	110	

Group 1: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
Constantinople (Ecumenical patriarchate)		
Ecological stations	110	
Educational institutions	110	
Electronic discussion groups	130	
Embassies	110	
Events	111	Events that are formally convened, directed toward a common goal, capable of being reconvened, and that have a formal name. See H 1592 for a list of types of events to be established in the name authority file.
Exhibitions	111	
Expeditions, Military	111	Headings in this category are military expeditions that are not campaigns, battles, sieges, etc. Military expeditions that are campaigns, battles, sieges, etc., are Group 2 and established as subject headings tagged 150.
Expeditions, Scientific	111	
Experiment stations	110	
Expositions	111	
Factories	110	
Fairs	111	
Festivals and celebrations	111	
Fictitious characters (Individual)	100	Headings in this category are for individual fictitious characters. Headings for groups of fictitious characters are established as subject headings, tagged 150, and qualified by (Fictitious characters).
Fish hatcheries	110	
Folk festivals and celebrations	111	
Forest districts	151	
Forests (Administrative agencies)	110	Headings in this category are always qualified by the term (Agency). Headings for forests as geographic entities are in Group 2, established as subject headings, tagged 151, and qualified according to subject cataloging conventions.
Funds	110	
Funeral homes, mortuaries	110	
Galleries	110	

Group 1: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
Games (Events)	111	
Gangs	110	
Gods (Individual)	100	Headings in this category are for individual gods. Headings for groups of gods are established as subject headings, tagged 150, and qualified by (… deities).
Halfway houses	110	
Helplines, hotlines	110	
Herbariums	110	
Hospitals	110	
Hotels	110	
Housing projects	110	
Individual works of art	100, 110, 130	
Industrial districts	110	
Internment camps	110	
Jurisdictions, Ancient (other than cities)	151	
Jurisdictions, Medieval and modern (including former jurisdictions)	151	
Laboratories	110	
Legendary characters (Individual)	100	Headings in this category are for individual legendary characters. Headings for groups of legendary characters are established as subject headings, tagged 150, and qualified by (Legendary characters).
Libraries	110	
Library districts	110	
Markets	110	
Military installations (active; also all after 1899)	151	
Mining districts	151	
Monasteries	110	
Morgues	110	
Mosques	110	
Motels	110	
Motion pictures	130	

Group 1: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
Museums	110	
Mythological figures (Individual)	100	Headings in this category are for individual mythological figures. Headings for groups of mythological figures are established as subject headings, tagged 150, and qualified by (… mythology).
Named collections	110	
Night clubs	110	
Nursing homes	110	
Observatories	110	
Old age homes	110	
Opera companies	110	
Parades	110	
Park districts	151	
Parks (Administrative agencies)	110	Headings in this category are always qualified by the term (Agency). Headings for parks as geographic entities are in Group 2, established as subject headings, tagged 151, and qualified according to subject cataloging conventions.
Planetariums	110	
Planned communities	151	
Plans (Programs)	110	
Poorhouses	110	
Port authorities	110	
Prisons	110	
Projects, Plans, etc.	110	
Public celebrations, pageants, anniversaries	111	
Publishers' imprints	110	
Pueblos	151	
Races (Contests)	111	
Radio programs	130	
Railroads	110	
Recreation districts	151	
Refugee camps	110	
Religious denominations	110	
Research parks	110	Headings in this category are for areas of land that are devoted to institutions carrying out

Group 1: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
		academic or industrial research. Geographic headings for parks intended for recreation, conservation, etc., are Group 2.
Research stations	110	
Reserves (Administrative agencies)	110	Headings in this category are always qualified by the term (Agency). Headings for reserves as geographic entities are in Group 2, established as subject headings, tagged 151, and qualified according to subject cataloging conventions.
Restaurants	110	
Sanatoriums	110	
Sanitation districts	151	
Satellites, Artificial	110	
School districts	110	
Schools	110	
Service stations	110	
Ships	110	
Shipyards	110	
Shopping centers	110	
Shows (Exhibitions)	111	
Software, Computer	130	
Sound recording labels	110	
Space vehicles	110	
Sporting events	111	
Stock exchanges	110	
Stores, Retail	110	
Studies (Research projects)	110	
Synagogues	110	
Telescopes	110	
Television programs	130	
Temples (in use; excludes temples in ruins)	110	
Theater companies	110	
Tournaments	111	
Treaties, etc.	130, 110, 111	

Group 1: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
Tribes (as legal entities only; U.S. and Canada only)	151	
Truck stops	110	
Undertakers	110	
Universities	110	
Utility districts	151	
Video games, Individual	130	Headings for individual video games are in Group 1 and established as titles. Headings for video game franchises are in Group 2, established as topical subject headings.
Water districts	151	
Web sites	130	
Works of art, Individual	100, 110, 130	
Zoological gardens	110	

G. Group 2 entities: Subject authority headings

Group 2 contains named entities always established according to subject cataloging conventions with authority records that reside in either the name authority file or the subject authority file.

A-C | D-K | L-R | S-Z

Group 2: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
Amusement park rides	110, 150	Headings for individual amusement park rides are tagged 110. Headings for themed amusement park rides that exist in multiple amusement parks are tagged as 150.
Amusement parks	151	Headings in this category are qualified according to subject cataloging conventions. Headings for parks as corporate bodies are in Group 1, established as name headings, tagged 110, and qualified by the term (Agency).
Apartment houses	110	
Aqueducts	151	
Arches	150	
Arenas	110	

Group 2: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
Artists' groups	150	Headings in this category include artists', composers', etc., groups that are often informally organized, may not be self-named, and do not play a role in collectively promoting and marketing their work. Headings for artists', composers', etc., groups that are self-identified by a particular name and function as a business firm in creating, publishing, promoting, and marketing their works are established as corporate entities according to descriptive cataloging conventions.
Asian conglomerate corporations	110	
Astronomical features (asteroids, comets, galaxies, planets, etc.)	151	
Auditoriums	110	
Awards	150	
Bathhouses	110	
Baths, Ancient	110	
Bridges	151	
Building details	150	Although headings in this category are generally tagged 150, headings that belong to a different category on this list may be tagged 110 (e.g., Auditoriums).
Buildings, Private	110	
Buildings occupied by corporate bodies	110	This category consists of buildings known by different names from the corporate bodies that occupy them. For buildings that are known by the same name as the bodies that occupy them, see H 1334, Background statement.
Bus terminals	110	
Camps	151	
Canals	151	
Capitols	110	
Castles	110	
Celestial bodies	151	
Cemetery sites, Archaeological	151	Headings in this category include the term Site in the heading and are qualified according to subject cataloging conventions. Headings for

Group 2: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
		named cemeteries as corporate bodies are in Group 1, established as name headings, tagged 110.
Chapels (building details or parts of complex structures)	150	Headings in this category are for chapels that are building details or parts of complex structures. See H 1334 sec. 5-6 for information on establishing building details and parts of complex structures. Headings for chapels that are free-standing; that is, they are not building details nor parts of complex structures, are in Group 1, established as name headings, and tagged 110.
Cities, Extinct (Pre-1500)	151	
City halls	110	
Civic centers	110	
Clans	100	
Club houses	110	
Coliseums	110	
Collective farms	151	
Community centers	110	
Composers' groups	150	Headings in this category include artists', composers', etc., groups that are often informally organized, may not be self-named, and do not play a role in collectively promoting and marketing their work. Headings for artists', composers', etc., groups that are self-identified by a particular name and function as a business firm in creating, publishing, promoting, and marketing their works are established as corporate entities according to descriptive cataloging conventions.
Computer languages	150	
Computer networks	150	
Computer systems	150	
Convention centers	110	
Courthouses	110	
Customhouses	110	
Details, Building	150	
Docks	151	

Group 2: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
Doors	150	
Dwellings	110	
Estates	151	
Events	150	Events that generally cannot be repeated and have no formal name but are commonly referred to by generic terms only. See H 1592 for a list of types of events to be established in the subject authority file.
Exhibition buildings	110	
Expeditions, Military	150	Headings in this category are military expeditions that are campaigns, battles, sieges, etc. Military expeditions that are not campaigns, battles, sieges, etc., are Group 1, established according to descriptive cataloging conventions, and tagged 111.
Fairgrounds	151	
Families	100	
Farms	151	
Feasts	150	
Ferry buildings	110	
Fictitious characters (Groups)	150	Headings in this category are for groups of fictitious characters and are qualified by (Fictitious characters). Headings for individual fictitious characters are in Group 1, established as name headings, and tagged 100.
Fire stations	110	
Forests (Geographic entities)	151	Headings in this category are qualified according to subject cataloging conventions. Headings for forests as corporate bodies are in Group 1, established as name headings, tagged 110, and qualified by the term (Agency).
Fortresses (Structures)	151	
Fountains	150	
Gardens	151	
Gates	150	
Gods (Groups)	150	Headings in this category are for groups of gods and are qualified by (… deities). Headings for individual gods are in Group 1, established as name headings, and tagged 100.

Group 2: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
Golf courses	151	
Grain elevators	110	
Gymnasiums	110	
Hazardous waste sites	151	
Highways	151	
Historic sites (including historic districts not in cities)	151	
Immigration stations	110	
Islands, Nonjurisdictional	151	
Land grants	151	
Legendary characters (Groups)	150	Headings in this category are for groups of legendary characters and are qualified by (Legendary characters). Headings for individual legendary characters are in Group 1, established as name headings, and tagged 100.
Lighthouses	110	
Locks (Hydraulic engineering)	151	
Locomotives	150	
Manors	110	
Mansions	110	
Market buildings	110	
Military installations (inactive pre-1900 installations)	151	
Mine buildings	110	
Mines	151	
Mints	110	
Monuments (Structures, statues, etc.)	150	
Music halls	110	
Mythological figures (Groups)	150	Headings in this category are for groups of mythological figures and are qualified by (… mythology). Headings for individual mythological figures are in Group 1, established as name headings, and tagged 100.
Office buildings	110	
Opera houses	110	
Palaces	110	

Group 2: Type of entity	**MARC tag**	**Notes**
Parks (Geographic entities)	151	Headings in this category are qualified according to subject cataloging conventions. Headings for parks as corporate bodies are in Group 1, established as name headings, tagged 110, and qualified by the term (Agency).
Pavilions	110	
Pipelines	151	
Playgrounds	151	
Plazas (Open spaces, squares, etc.)	151	
Police stations	110	
Pools, Public	110	
Ports (Physical facilities)	151	
Post offices	110	
Posthouses	110	
Power plants	110	
Presidential mansions	110	
Public comfort stations	110	
Racetracks	110	
Railway stations	110	
Ranches	151	
Ranger stations	110	
Recreation areas	151	
Remote-controlled vehicles	150	
Reservations, Indian	151	
Reserves (Parks, forests, etc.)	151	
Resorts	110	
Roads	151	
Rooms	150	
Sanitary landfills	151	
Satellites (i.e., moons)	151	
Schools of artists	150	
Shrines (not churches)	150	
Spas	110	
Sports arenas	110	
Sports facilities	110	
Stadiums	110	

Group 2: Type of entity	MARC tag	Notes
Stagecoach stations	110	
Streets	151	
Structures (Non-geographic, for example, towers)	150	
Temples (In ruins)	110	
Terminal buildings	110	
Theater buildings	110	
Theme parks	151	
Tombs	150	
Towers	150	
Trails	151	
Tribes (Ethnic groups)	150	
Tunnels	151	
Video game franchises	150	Headings for individual video games are in Group 1 and established as titles. Headings for video game franchises are in Group 2, established as topical subject headings.
Villas	110	
Walls	150, 151	Walls that were built as military installations (e.g., the Great Wall of China, Hadrian's Wall, individual city walls) are tagged 151. All other walls are tagged 150.
Waterways	151	
Wells	151	

Revision history

2026-04: Corrected typo.

2025-08: Corrected typo. Added Group 1 and 2 to table column titles.

2025-06: Updated template. Fixed missing text.

2024-12: Updated to current template; added Treaties, etc. to Group 1 and corrected typo.